Narendra Modi's messaging in 2014 but many turned away in 2019. Vote shares tell the deeper story. In 2009, the BJP won only 15.2 per cent of the votes in Muslim-significant seats. This dramatically increased to 44.6 per cent in 2014 and 45.6 per cent in 2019. Moreover, the BJP in UP had not managed to attract more than 40 per cent of votes in even a single Muslim seat in 2009. In 2014, it did so in eight seats, and by 2019 in as many as eleven seats. In other words, the BJP won more than 40 per cent of the vote in an overwhelming majority—as many as 84.6 per cent—of Muslim-significant seats in UP in 2019. Essentially, the BJP's fortunes rose in Muslim-significant areas because of the much sharper counter-mobilisation by Hindus in the party's favour.

Figure 5.2: The BJP Expanded Its Base in Muslim-significant Seats in UP (Lok Sabha: 2009–2019)